

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B-Eligibility Factors (FITAP)
	Section No./Name	B-1800 Drug Testing (FITAP)
	Document No./Name	B-1820-FITAP ES Screening
	Effective Date	September 1, 2015

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

*** Certain adult **** FITAP applicants and recipients age 18 and over will be screened by the ES worker for the possible use of or dependence on illegal drugs at:

- Change report,
- the initial application for FITAP benefits, and
- at each redetermination of continued eligibility.

Applicants and recipients are to be advised that use of or dependence on illegal drugs will not, in itself, negatively impact their eligibility.

For applications, do not complete the screening until eligibility based on other factors has been established. Do not screen if the application is to be denied.

II. PROCEDURES

B-1821-FITAP - PR RESULTS OF ES SCREENING

If the response to any question on the [DAST 20](#) indicates possible use of or dependence on illegal drugs, the recipient shall be referred to Office of Behavioral Health (OBH) for:

- additional screening,
- possible urine testing,
- education,
- treatment, and
- rehabilitation services, where necessary.

Note: If the applicant/recipient indicates they have already completed a treatment program, the applicant/recipient should still be referred to OBH. OBH will determine whether additional treatment is necessary.

B-1822-FITAP - PR SCREENING AT APPLICATION

ES screening is accomplished through the use of the [DAST 20](#) screening form administered by staff. Prior to completion of the [DAST 20](#), give the client form [OFS DT 1](#) and fully explain the purpose of drug testing policy (see [B-1810-FITAP](#)). This explanation must include an explanation of the screening referral to OBH, the cooperation requirements and the sanctions for failure to participate. After providing this information to the client, as appropriate, administer the [DAST 20](#) either by telephone or in a face-to-face interview. If no further referral to OBH is required, enter a case note upon completion of the [DAST 20](#).

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B-1822-1-FITAP - PR SCREENING AT REDETERMINATION

At redetermination, send form [OFS 18C](#) scheduling a telephone interview for the completion of the [DAST 20](#) prior to the end of the certification period. If no further referral to OBH is required, enter a case note upon completion of the [DAST 20](#).

B-1822-2-FITAP - PR SCREENING AT CHANGE REPORT

When a *** required **** household member age 18 or older is added to an active FITAP case, a drug screening questionnaire must be administered. Send form [OFS 18C](#) and/or [OFS 12](#) scheduling a telephone interview for the completion of the [DAST 20](#) prior to including the household member. If no further referral to OBH is required, enter a case note upon completion of the [DAST 20](#).

B-1823-FITAP - PR REASONABLE CAUSE

Refer recipients to OBH at any time there is reasonable cause to suspect that a recipient is using or is dependent on illegal drugs. This may be based on direct observation or on reliable information indicating the use of or dependence on illegal drugs received from a reliable source.

Referrals to OBH on the basis of observation or reliable information from a reliable source must be approved by a supervisor.

It is not necessary to complete the [DAST 20](#) prior to referral to OBH when the referral is based on observation or on reliable information from an outside source.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

[OFS DT 1 Form/Instructions Drug Testing, Education and Rehabilitation Program](#)

[OFS 18C Form/Instructions Client Contact Letter](#)

[DAST 20 Form/Instructions Drug Use Questionnaire](#)

IV. REFERENCES

[LAC 67:III.1249](#)

[R.S. 46:460.10](#)